

TygaStyle — Production Deployment Plan

Tiger E-commerce hosting proposal · July 2026

Boss-ready hosting plan for the Tiger E-commerce monorepo: Next.js storefront + Strapi 5 CMS, Rwanda market (MTN MoMo USSD + WhatsApp). Prices are vendor list rates as of July 2026; taxes and FX may vary. FX assumed $\approx$ 1,420 RWF per 1 USD.

Executive summary

Recommendation: Start with Option B (all on Render, self-hosted Strapi) at about \$52/mo ($\sim$ 73,840 RWF). It matches the existing Docker/Render path, stays always-on, and avoids Strapi Cloud sleep on the Starter tier. Move to Option A if you want zero CMS ops and managed backups ($\sim$ \$97/mo).

- **Monthly hosting (recommended):** $\sim$ \$52–\$110 depending on option
- **Year-1 hosting (Option B + buffer):** $\sim$ \$733 ($\sim$ 1,040,860 RWF)
- **Go-live timeline:** $\sim$ 5 working days / $\sim$ 1 week
- **Payment gateway fees (current design):** \$0 — MTN MoMo USSD only

1. What we are deploying

Two apps, one database, media storage. No Redis, no Stripe, and no email provider are required by the current codebase.

Component	Tech	Role	Must stay up?
Storefront	Next.js 16 (Docker)	Shop, cart, MoMo, WhatsApp	Yes — public site
CMS / Admin	Strapi 5	Products, stock, orders, homepage	Yes — API + staff
Database	PostgreSQL	Catalog + orders	Yes
Media	Uploads / CDN	Product images ($\sim$ 100 MB today)	Yes
Payments	MTN MoMo *182*...*55066#	USSD; no card PSP	N/A (external)
Contact	WhatsApp +250 784 815 151	Order follow-up links	N/A (external)

2. Target architecture

Browser $\rightarrow$ Next.js storefront (HTTPS) $\rightarrow$ Strapi REST API $\rightarrow$ PostgreSQL + media storage.

- **Storefront (public):** Next.js standalone on port 3000. Custom domain + TLS. Build-time env for Strapi URL and site URL.
- **CMS (staff):** Strapi 5 admin + REST API. CORS locked to shop domain. Secrets for JWT / APP_KEYS.
- **Data:** Managed Postgres + disk or CDN. Start small (1 GB RAM DB, 5–50 GB media); scale later.

3. Hosting options compared

Monthly run-rate for a small boutique (low–medium traffic). Domain and one-time setup are listed separately.

Option	Stack	\$ / mo	$\approx$ RWF / mo	Year-1 host	Ops	Fit
A · Managed CMS	Render Starter (\$7) + Strapi Cloud Pro (\$90)	\$97	137,740 RWF	\$1,164	Low	Easiest CMS; always-on
B · Best value ★	Render: Next (\$7) + Strapi (\$25) + Postgres (\$19) + disk ($\sim$ \$1)	\$52	73,840 RWF	\$624	Medium	Recommended launch

Option	Stack	\$ / mo	≈ RWF / mo	Year-1 host	Ops	Fit
C · Premium FE	Vercel Pro (\$20) + Strapi Cloud Pro (\$90)	\$110	156,200 RWF	\$1,320	Low	Best CDN / DX for Next

Important: Avoid free tiers for real customers (Render Free web, free Postgres, Strapi Cloud sleep on Starter). Fine for demos; not for a live shop. Strapi Cloud Starter is \$35/mo but sleeps when idle — skip for production unless you upgrade to Pro.

4. Option B detail (recommended)

Pros: always-on, predictable bill, uses existing Dockerfile. Cons: you own backups, upgrades, and disk growth. Paid Render Postgres includes a point-in-time recovery window.

Line item	Spec	Price
Web service — storefront	Starter · 512 MB	\$7
Web service — Strapi	Standard · 2 GB	\$25
Render Postgres	Basic-1gb	\$19
Persistent disk (uploads)	~5 GB × \$0.25	~\$1
Workspace	Hobby	\$0
Included bandwidth	5 GB then \$0.15/GB	usually \$0 early

5. Options A and C (summary)

Option A — Managed CMS: Render Starter for Next.js + Strapi Cloud Pro (1M API requests, 250 GB assets, weekly backups, always-on). Best if nobody wants to babysit Postgres. Higher fixed cost.

Option C — Premium frontend: Vercel Pro seat (\$20 + usage credit) for Next.js + Strapi Cloud Pro. Best global CDN and preview deploys; slightly more expensive until traffic or marketing needs it.

6. One-time & annual extras

Item	Est. cost	Notes
Domain .rw (local registry)	~15,000 RWF / yr (~\$11)	register.rw / RICTA
Domain .com (optional)	~\$12–18 / yr	Or ~25,000 RWF via register.rw
TLS / HTTPS	\$0	Included on Render / Vercel / Strapi Cloud
DNS (Cloudflare free)	\$0	Optional
MTN MoMo merchant	Existing (code 55066)	No online gateway fee in current design
Email / SMS / Stripe	\$0 now	Not wired; add later if needed
Engineering setup time	16–24 hours	Accounts, secrets, deploy, DNS, smoke tests

7. Year-1 budget

Recommended Option B: hosting \$624/year + domain ~\$15 + 15% contingency ≈ **\$733** (~1,040,860 RWF).

Scenario	Monthly	Year-1 (host + domain + 15% buffer)
Lean (Option B) ★	\$52	\$733
Managed (Option A)	\$97	\$1,354
Premium FE (Option C)	\$110	\$1,533

8. Launch timeline (~5 working days)

Day	Work	Owner	Exit criteria
1	Accounts, billing card, domain, secrets checklist	Dev + finance	Render + domain registered
2	Deploy Strapi + Postgres; secrets; seed/import catalog	Dev	Admin login; products via API
3	Deploy Next.js; wire CORS FRONTEND_URL	Dev	Shop on staging with live catalog
4	DNS + TLS; WhatsApp; MoMo smoke test	Dev + ops	HTTPS domain; test order E2E
5	Staff training, backup check, go-live	Dev + business	Production live; rollback noted

9. Go-live checklist

Technical

- Production secrets rotated (not from backup env files)
- NEXT_PUBLIC_STRAPI_URL + SITE_URL set at build time
- FRONTEND_URL in Strapi CORS allowlist
- DATABASE_SSL on for managed Postgres
- Media uploads persist (disk or Cloud CDN)
- Admin user created; seed disabled after import

Business

- Confirm MoMo merchant code 55066
- Confirm WhatsApp number on all CTAs
- Staff can edit products / mark orders paid
- Domain points to storefront only (not admin)
- Optional: Cloudflare DNS + basic WAF
- Document who pays the monthly invoice

10. Decision ask

Approve Option B at ~\$52/mo (~73,840 RWF) plus domain, with a year-1 ceiling near \$733 including buffer — or choose Option A if managed CMS is worth the extra ~\$45/mo.

Prices exclude VAT/local taxes. Confirm on vendor dashboards before purchase; Strapi, Render, and Vercel update list prices periodically. Sources: strapi.io/pricing-cloud, render.com/pricing, vercel.com/pricing, register.rw (July 2026).

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